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Research Track

CAIN 2027

Call for Submissions Review Instructions

Call for Submissions

We invite submissions of papers in two categories:

- **Full research papers (up to 10+2 pages):** Full research papers describe empirical or theoretical research results, e.g., based on a controlled experiment, questionnaire survey, case study, or mathematical modeling, or introduce a novel design contribution, e.g., a conceptual framework or tool-supported approach. Design Contributions presented in full research papers must be appropriately evaluated. Secondary studies, replication studies, and negative results are also welcome. A full research paper is up to 10 pages, plus a maximum of 2 pages for references.
- **Short research (up to 5+2 pages):** Short research papers are opportunities for research-oriented position papers or new idea papers worth discussing with the community, but perhaps not yet fully evaluated. For example, a short paper might identify and describe important challenges or present visionary new solution ideas (no evaluation required). Preliminary research results are also appropriate for a short paper. A short paper is up to 5 pages, plus a maximum of 2 pages for references.

Each paper submission will undergo a double-anonymous review process with three independent reviews and a virtual PC discussion. Acceptance criteria include relevance to the CAIN scope, novelty, rigor, verifiability & transparency, and presentation. The accepted full and short papers will be published in the ICSE Companion proceedings, and at least one author needs to register for CAIN'27 to present the paper in person.

Full paper submissions that do not meet the program committee's expectations may be reevaluated and accepted as short papers. If accepted as a short paper, authors can choose to accept or decline to publish as a short paper. Rejected papers may also be invited to the poster track.

Scope and Topics of Interest

The scope of CAIN is **Software Engineering for AI-Enabled Systems**, or **AI Engineering** for short, that is, the use and innovation of software engineering principles and techniques to build software systems that use one or more AI/ML models. CAIN papers often apply, expand, adapt, or invent **software engineering principles** to the engineering of AI-enabled systems. See the dedicated scope page for more details.

Relevant topics therefore include, but are not limited to:

- Engineering principles, architecture, and quality assurance for **agentic software**, especially beyond coding agents
- **Requirements engineering** for AI-enabled systems, e.g., elicitation, specification, or management, and the relationship of system, user, and model requirements.
- System-level **security and safety engineering** strategies for systems with AI components.
- **Data management** for AI-enabled systems to ensure relevance and efficiency related to stakeholder goals.
- **System and software architecture** for AI-enabled systems, e.g., architecture modeling, architectural tactics, architecture/design patterns, or reference architectures.

- Integration of AI and software development activities into the **AI engineering life cycle**, e.g., continuous integration and deployment, operation and monitoring, and system and software evolution.
- **Quality assurance** and management of system quality attributes and their relationships to AI/ML properties, including runtime properties such as performance, efficiency, safety, security, and reliability, and life-cycle properties such as reusability, maintainability, evolvability, and observability.
- **Collaboration, organizational, and management practices** for the successful engineering of AI-enabled systems.
- Building effective **infrastructures** to support the development and operation of AI-enabled systems and components.
- Software engineering methods and tools for next-gen AI-enabled systems, e.g., systems that integrate foundation models or AI agents.

The first three topics of agentic software, requirements engineering, and security/safety are a particular focus of interest for CAIN 2027.

Note on Scope: Submissions that report predominantly on data science or AI/ML algorithms without any or only minor connection to software engineering for AI-enabled systems will be desk-rejected. There are many venues for data science and AI/ML papers, where authors would get much more valuable and relevant feedback. More details on the scope are available here (https://conf.researchr.org/track/cain-2027/cain-2027-cain-scope).

Submission Form

All research papers should be submitted to HotCrp (https://cain27.hotcrp.com/). The submission deadline is firm, no extensions.

All submissions must adhere to the following requirements:

- Page limit is 10 pages plus 2 additional pages of references for full papers and 5 pages plus 2 additional page of references for short papers.
- Submissions must be unpublished original work and must not be under review or submitted elsewhere while being under consideration. Contravention of this concurrent submission policy will be deemed a serious breach of scientific ethics, and appropriate action will be taken in all such cases.
- By submitting to CAIN, authors acknowledge that they are aware of and agree to be bound by the ACM Policy and Procedures on Plagiarism (https://www.acm.org/publications/policies/plagiarism-overview) and IEEE Plagiarism FAQ (https://www.ieee.org/publications/rights/plagiarism/plagiarism.html). The authors also acknowledge that they conform to the authorship policy of the ACM (https://www.acm.org/publications/policies/new-acm-policy-on-authorship) and the authorship policy of the IEEE (https://journals.ieeeauthorcenter.ieee.org/become-an-ieee-journal-author/publishing-ethics/definition-of-authorship/). This includes for example, the guidelines on using the Use of Artificial Intelligence (https://www.acm.org/publications/policies/new-acm-policy-on-authorship).
- Paper review will employ a double-anonymous review process. Thus, no submission may reveal its authors' identities. The authors must make every effort to honor the double-anonymous review process. In particular:
    - Authors' names must be omitted from the submitted paper.
    - All references to the authors' prior work should be in the third person (do not omit or anonymize the references themselves).
    - Linked artifact repositories need to be anonymized.
    - While we allow the posting of preprints on arXiv or similar sites, authors are encouraged to change the title of their submission to make the accidental discovery by reviewers less likely. During the review period, authors must not publicly use the submission title, e.g., by advertising the paper on social media.

All submissions must conform to the IEEE conference proceedings template, specified in the IEEE Conference Proceedings Formatting Guidelines (ieee.org/conferences/publishing/templates.html) (title in 24pt font and full text in 10pt type, LaTeX users must use `\documentclass[10pt,conference]{IEEEtran}` without including the `compsoc` or `compsocconf` options). Note that the IEEE format is being used this year, whereas last year it was the ACM format.

Accepted papers will be published in the ICSE 2027 Co-located Event Proceedings and included in the IEEE and ACM Digital Libraries. Authors of accepted papers are required to register and present their accepted paper at the conference for the paper to be included in the proceedings and the Digital Libraries. The presentation may be in the format of a talk or a poster.

The official publication date is the date the proceedings are made available in the ACM or IEEE Digital Libraries. This date may be up to two weeks prior to the first day of ICSE 2027. The official publication date affects the deadline for any patent filings related to published work. Purchase of additional pages in the proceedings is not allowed.

Authors of rejected full papers may receive an acceptance as a short paper if the PC chairs and reviewers agree that it better meets the criteria for short papers. In this case, the authors may accept or decline the invitation if they would rather submit as a full paper to a different venue.

Similarly, authors of rejected full and short papers relevant to the field of AI engineering may be invited to publish their papers in a different CAIN track, such as the Posters track. In this case, authors may decide to accept or reject the invitation.

Open Science Policy

CAIN encourages authors of research papers to follow the principles of transparency, reproducibility, and replicability. The guiding principle is that all major research results should be accessible to the public, and, if possible, empirical studies should be reproducible. In particular, the conference supports the adoption of open data and open-source principles and strongly encourages authors to disclose their (anonymized and curated) data and study artifacts. Note that **sharing is expected to be the default**, and non-sharing needs to be justified. We acknowledge that there are valid reasons why sharing is not possible, practical, or desirable, e.g., privacy restrictions or non-disclosure agreements. We also recognize that full reproducibility or replicability is usually not feasible in qualitative research and that, similar to industrial studies, qualitative studies often face challenges in sharing research data.

Note that artifact repositories also need to be anonymized for review. Final artifact repositories of accepted submissions should be submitted to an institutional or open platform committed to long-term archiving, which ideally also creates a DOI for the repository, e.g., Zenodo (https://zenodo.org) or Figshare (https://figshare.com). Source code contributions like reusable tools may also be suitably shared on, e.g., GitHub (https://github.com). In that case, we recommend using https://anonymous.4open.science (https://anonymous.4open.science) for the anonymous initial submission and, on acceptance, archiving the respective version via Zenodo (see this guide (https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/archiving-a-github-repository/referencing-and-citing-content)).

Withdrawing a Paper

Authors can withdraw their paper at any moment until the final decision has been made, through the paper submission system. Resubmitting the paper to another venue before the final decision has been made without withdrawing from CAIN 2027 first is considered a violation of the concurrent submission policy, and will lead to automatic rejection from CAIN 2027 as well as any other venue adhering to this policy. Such violations may also be reported to appropriate organizations e.g. ACM and IEEE.

Important Dates	AoE (UTC-12h)

Fri 30 Oct 2026
Submission deadline

Mon 11 Jan 2027
Notifications

Fri 29 Jan 2027
Camera ready deadline

Program Committee (https://conf.researchr.org/committee/cain-2027/cain-2027-call-for-papers-program-committee)



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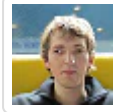
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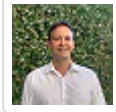
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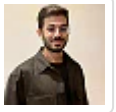
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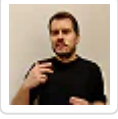
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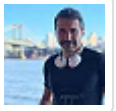
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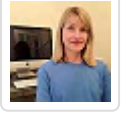
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